They are

A. Autocratic or Authoritarian Leadership:

An autocratic leader exercises complete control over the subordinates. He centralises power in himself and takes all decisions without consulting the subordinates. He dominates and drives his group through pressure or force. The leader gives orders and expects the subordinates to follow them without questioning. He uses rewards and holds threat of penalties to direct the subordinates. Autocratic leadership style may be appropriate when subordinates are uneducated, unskilled and submissive.

Advantages:

- Autocratic leadership style permits quick decision making
- It gives strong motivation and satisfaction to the leader who dictates terms.
- Less competent subordinates are needed at lower level.
- This style may yield positive results in prompt situation.

Disadvantages:

- Autocratic style leads to frustration, low morale and conflict among subordinates.
- Full potential of subordinates and their creative ideas are not utilized.
- Organisational continuity is threatened in the absence of the leader because a subordinate gets no opportunity for development.



Figure 7.4 Adolph Hitler Autocratic Leader

DO YOU KNOW? **Adolph Hitler was an autocratic leader because nobody in his regime had right to interfere or comment on his decision. They just want to obey and follow his orders without questioning.**

B. Democratic or Participative Leadership:

A consultative or democratic takes decision in consultation and participate with the subordinates. He decentralises authority and allows the subordinates to share his power. The leader does what the group wants and follows the majority opinion. He keeps the followers informed about matters affecting them. A democratic leader provides freedom of thinking and expression. He listens the suggestion, grievances and opinions of the subordinates.

Advantages:

- Consultative leadership improves the job satisfaction and morale of subordinates.
- It cultivates the decision making ability of subordinates.
- The leader multiplies his ability through the contribution of his followers.
- It develops positive attitude of the leader and reduces resistance to change.
- The quality of decisions is improved.
- Labour absenteeism and Labour turnover is reduced.

Disadvantages:

- Democratic style is time-consuming and may result in delays in decision-making.

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